

EXPERT TIPS

Repeating a string

The code `print('Lives left: ' + heart_symbol * lives)` uses a neat trick to display a heart for each remaining life. You can tell Python to repeat a string a specific number of times by multiplying it by a number. For example, `print(heart_symbol * 10)` would display ten hearts. Try this code out in the shell.

```
>>> heart_symbol = u'\u2764'
>>> print(heart_symbol * 10)
♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥
```

11 Did you win?

When the game ends, you need to work out if the player has won. If the `guessed_word_correctly` variable is `True`, you know the loop ended before the player ran out of lives – so they've won the game. Otherwise (`else`), they've lost. Add this code to the end of your program.



```
lives = lives - 1

if guessed_word_correctly:
    print('You won! The secret word was ' + secret_word)
else:
    print('You lost! The secret word was ' + secret_word)
```

This is shorthand for
"if guessed_word_
correctly = True"



Don't forget to save
your work.

12 Test your code

Try the game to make sure it runs OK. If there's a problem, carefully check your code for bugs. When you've got it working, invite your friends to take the Nine Lives challenge!

```
['?', '?', '?', '?', '?']
Lives left: ♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥
Guess a letter or the whole word:
```

Just type a letter
to start playing!

